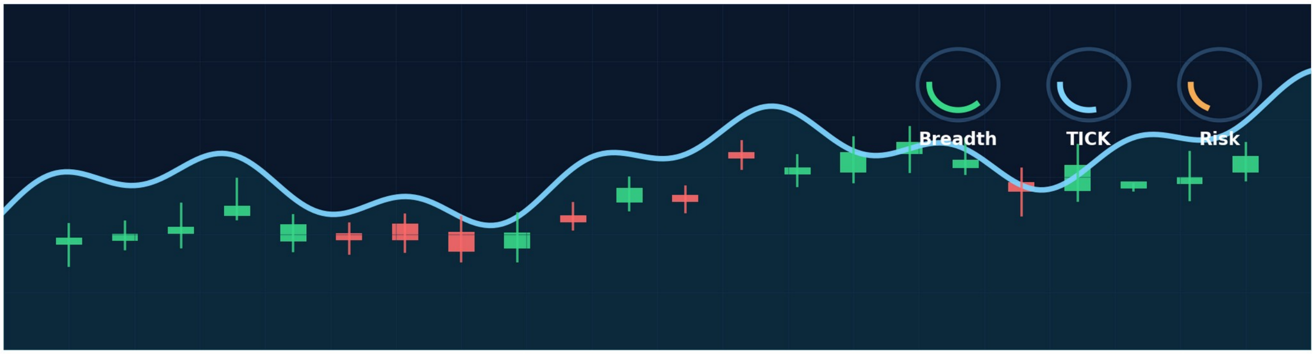


Intraday Momentum & 0DTE Trading Framework

A comprehensive training outline for beginner-to-intermediate traders

A practical guide to market type, price structure, breadth, NYSE TICK, product mechanics, risk control, and deliberate practice

What this guide helps you do	Who should use it
• Diagnose whether the day is likely to trend, rotate, or chop. • Use breadth and NYSE TICK as context tools instead of magic signals. • Choose a lower-complexity product before jumping into same-day options. • Build repeatable execution, risk, and review habits.	• New traders who need structure more than more indicators. • Intermediate traders who want better timing around intraday inflection points. • Anyone tempted by 0DTE who needs a risk-first framework.

Important risk note

This document is educational material, not investment advice. Options, futures, and leveraged intraday trading can lose money rapidly. Read the latest Characteristics and Risks of Standardized Options from the Options Clearing Corporation before trading live. If you are not consistently profitable in simulation, move down the leverage ladder rather than up it.

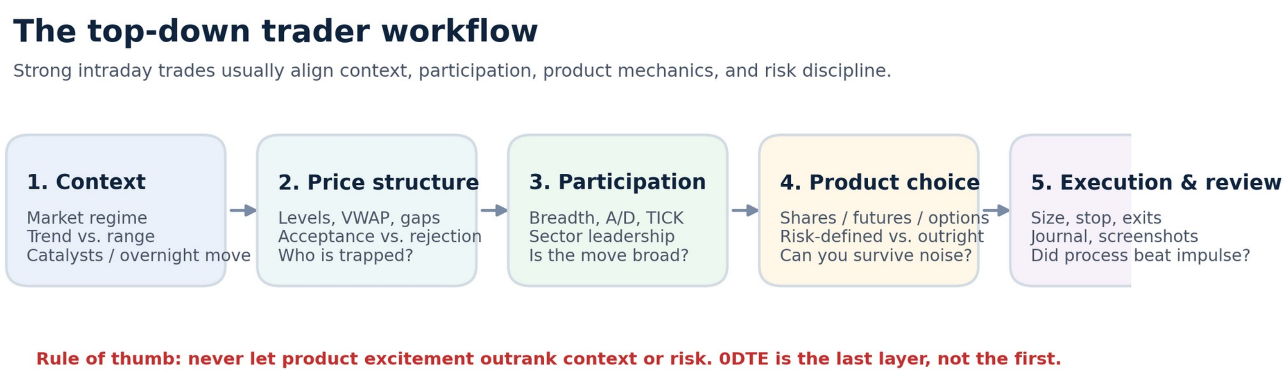
Core message

The strongest intraday decisions usually follow the same sequence: context first, then price structure, then participation, then timing, then product choice, then risk. Most avoidable losses come from reversing that order.

How to use this guide

Treat the material below as a framework, not a collection of isolated tricks. If you only remember one thing, remember this: price tells you where the battle is happening, market internals tell you who is participating, and product mechanics tell you how fast a good idea can still turn into a bad trade.

TL;DR	Start by defining the market type, mark the key levels, confirm whether participation supports the move, and only then look for an execution trigger.
Beginner	A good trade usually starts with a clear question: Is the market trending or rotating? Where is the nearest level that matters? If you cannot answer those two questions, wait.
Intermediate	Once a level is in play, use breadth, sector confirmation, and NYSE TICK to decide whether the move is likely to continue, stall, or exhaust.
Expert	Experts use internals as state variables rather than as standalone entries. They know that the same TICK spike means something very different at a clean inflection point than it does in the center of a noisy range.



Framework map: the cleanest intraday decisions move from context to execution, not the other way around.

Read the guide in this order	**What this guide is not**
• 1. Market type and key levels • 2. Breadth and participation • 3. NYSE TICK and intraday timing • 4. 0DTE mechanics and product choice • 5. Playbooks, risk, and review	• Not a promise that an indicator can predict every move • Not a substitute for a trading journal • Not a reason to skip simulation or oversize because the setup feels good

Rule of thumb: never let product excitement outrun market context. 0DTE is the last layer of the process, not the first.

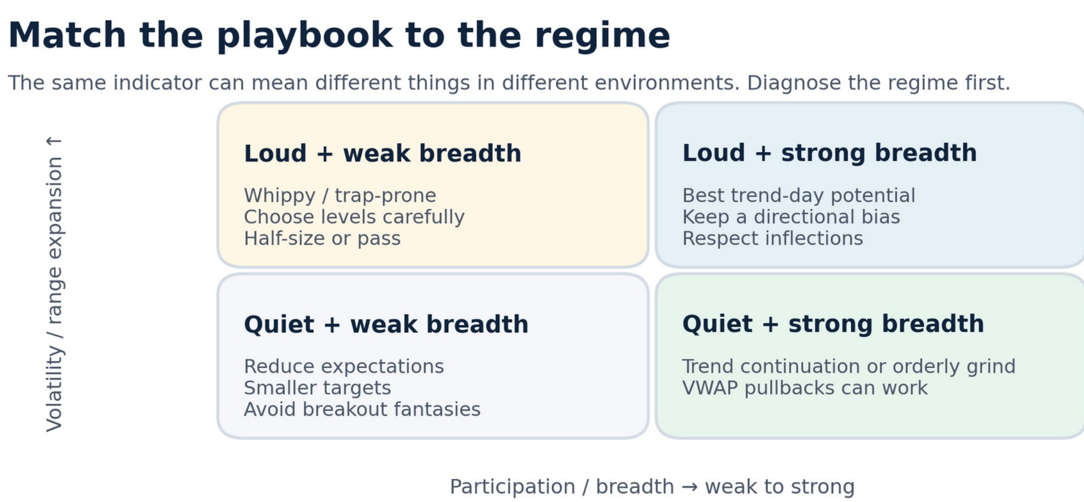
Part I - Market context and internals

The same chart pattern behaves differently depending on whether the market is in a trend, a balanced rotation, or an event-driven repricing. Diagnose the environment before you interpret the signal.

1. Diagnose the market type before you trade

Every intraday playbook depends on the environment. A breakout strategy needs acceptance and follow-through. A mean-reversion strategy needs exhaustion and reversion back toward value. If you use the right pattern in the wrong regime, the trade often fails even though the chart looked familiar.

TL;DR	First classify the day: trend, range, or high-volatility event session. The regime determines what setups have statistical room to work.
Beginner	A simple first pass is enough: are price swings holding direction, or is the market repeatedly snapping back toward VWAP and the opening area?
Intermediate	Intermediate traders add a top-down view: higher timeframe direction, overnight positioning, gap context, and the way the first 15 to 30 minutes interact with major levels.
Expert	Expert traders think in state changes. A day can begin as balance, transition into expansion, and then revert back into balance. The goal is not to label the day once; it is to stay aligned with the current state.



Regime matrix: the playbook should match the combination of breadth, volatility, and follow-through.

Trend-day clues	Range-day clues
• Gap or opening drive is accepted instead of fully reversed • Breadth is strong and stays strong • Pullbacks are shallow and mostly hold above VWAP	• Breaks above or below the early range are rejected • Breadth is mixed or improves only briefly • Price repeatedly rotates back through VWAP • The market spends more time auctioning than

in an uptrend or below VWAP in a downtrend • Breakouts do not immediately fail	expanding

Pre-open checklist

Before the bell, mark the prior day high and low, overnight high and low, obvious higher timeframe levels, scheduled economic events, and your expected scenarios. You do not need to predict the day. You need to know what would make you shift from continuation thinking to balance thinking, or vice versa.

2. Build the map: key levels and time-of-day behavior

Intraday momentum becomes tradable when it collides with a level that other traders also care about. Levels create decision points. Internals help you judge whether the market is likely to accept, reject, or pause at those points.

TL;DR	Levels matter because they define where the trade thesis is wrong. No level means no clean invalidation.
Beginner	For most new traders, the must-have levels are prior day high and low, overnight high and low, the opening range, and VWAP.
Intermediate	Intermediate traders add expected move boundaries, weekly levels, and major unfilled gaps so they can distinguish a normal pullback from a more meaningful test.
Expert	Experts map location and timing together. A retest of VWAP at 10:10 ET is not the same as a retest of VWAP at 14:35 ET. Time changes how order flow behaves.

High-value levels to mark	**Common time-of-day tendencies**
• Prior day high and prior day low • Overnight high and overnight low • The opening range high and low • VWAP and any obvious anchored VWAP reference you use • Expected move or major option-related inflection zone • Previous week high and low when they are nearby	• Opening minutes: fast information, fast traps • Late morning: often cleaner structure once the initial imbalance settles • Midday: thinner energy and easier fakeouts • Power hour / close: fast repricing, especially if a trend day persists or a late squeeze develops

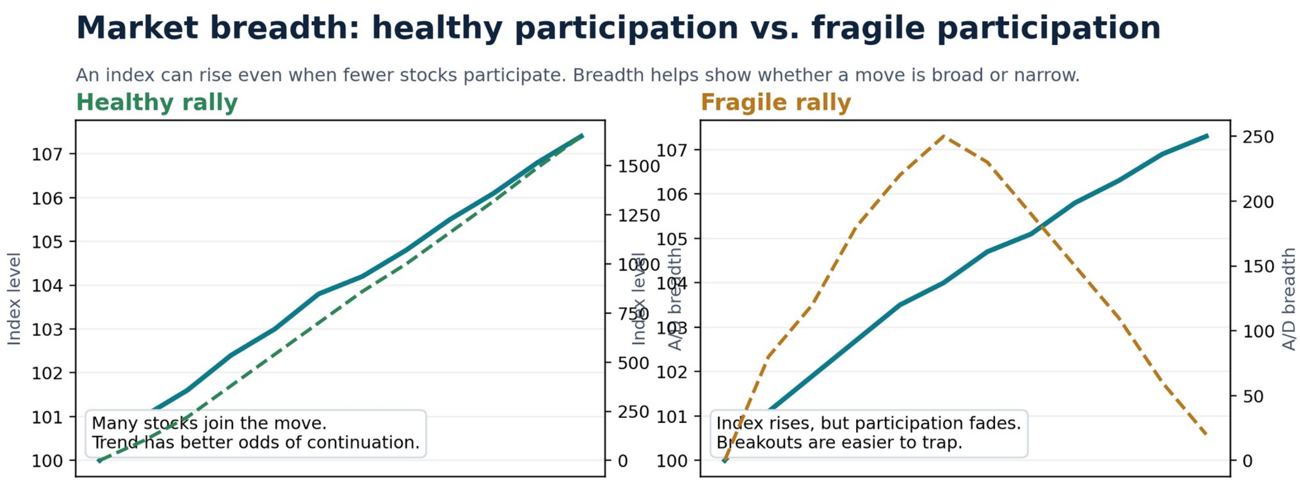
A useful beginner rule is to avoid treating every early impulse candle as a signal. First ask whether that candle changed location, changed participation, or simply changed the speed of noise.

3. Breadth tells you whether the move has help

Market breadth measures participation. When an index rises because many stocks are rising, continuation has a healthier foundation than when the index rises on the backs of only a few mega-cap names. Breadth does not replace price, but it helps you judge whether a move is broadly sponsored or fragile.

TL;DR	Breadth answers a simple question: how many stocks

	are helping the move?
Beginner	If the market is moving up and breadth is also improving, the move is usually easier to trust than a rally built on narrow leadership alone.
Intermediate	Intermediate traders compare index price with the advance-decline line, sector participation, and whether small caps or cyclicals are confirming the move.
Expert	Experts read breadth as market sponsorship. Strong breadth can support continuation even during a pause, while deteriorating breadth can warn that a breakout is losing internal support before price fully shows it.



Healthy participation vs. fragile participation: the path of price can look similar at first, but the quality of sponsorship is different.

What supportive breadth often looks like

- Advance-decline line rising with price instead of lagging badly
- More than one sector participating
- Small caps or broader indexes not fighting the move
- Pullbacks that reduce speed without fully destroying participation

Optional internals to know

- ADD / advance-decline issues: net advancing minus declining stocks
- A/D line: running participation trend through the session
- TRIN: relative pressure in advancing vs. declining volume
- Up volume / down volume: where the actual traded volume is leaning

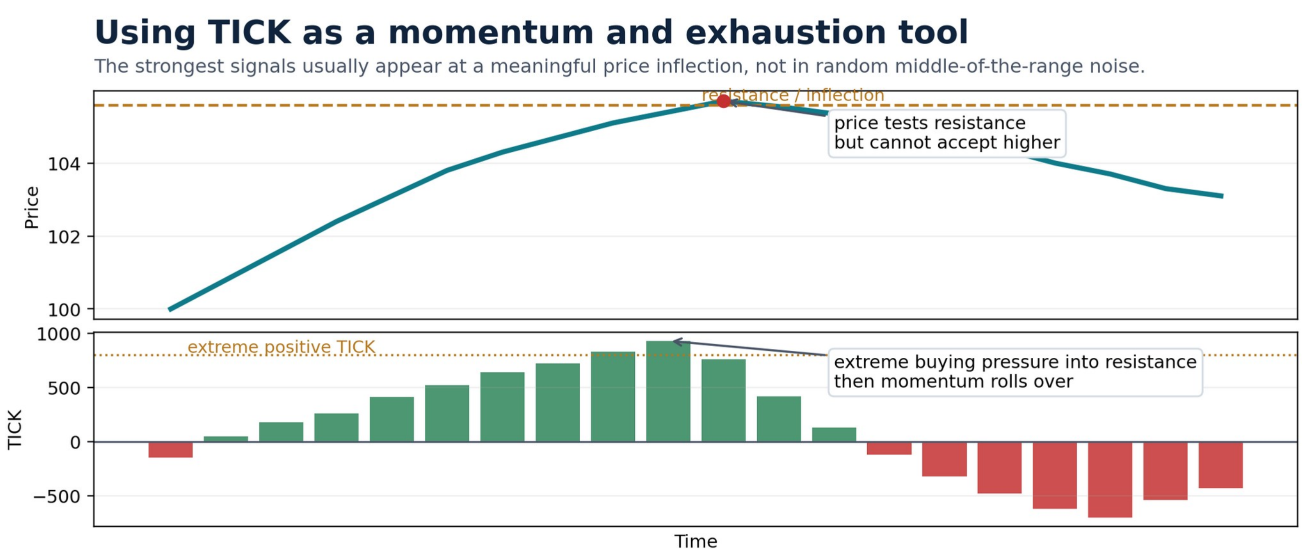
Breadth nuance

Breadth does not need to make a fresh extreme every minute for a trend to survive. What matters more is whether participation remains supportive enough that pullbacks look like resets rather than full internal breakdowns.

4. NYSE TICK: a timing and exhaustion tool, not a standalone system

NYSE TICK measures the number of stocks trading on an uptick minus the number trading on a downtick at a given moment. Think of it as a very short-term pulse of buying or selling pressure. Its value is highest at meaningful decision areas, not in the middle of random chop.

TL;DR	TICK is best used to time momentum acceleration or exhaustion at a level that already matters.
Beginner	A positive TICK surge can help confirm buyers are showing up, while a deeply negative TICK can confirm aggressive selling. But the reading only matters if price is doing something at a real level.
Intermediate	Intermediate traders watch whether TICK resets on a pullback and then re-expands in trend direction, or whether a new price extreme appears without comparable TICK confirmation.
Expert	Expert traders compare price, location, and TICK sequence together. A higher TICK reading with poor price progress can signal exhaustion; a less negative TICK at a new price low can hint that seller urgency is fading.



TICK is most informative around inflection points: price may still be pushing, but the internal pulse can warn that urgency is changing.

High-quality ways to use TICK

- At prior day high or low, opening range edges, VWAP tests, and expected move zones
- To judge whether a pullback is resetting or actually reversing the trend
- To confirm a rejection after an extended one-sided push

Poor ways to use TICK

- Buying or selling solely because a threshold was touched
- Reading every spike in the middle of a noisy range as predictive
- Ignoring whether breadth and structure agree with the signal

5. Put it together: price first, internals second

A strong trader does not ask, "What is TICK saying?" in isolation. The better question is, "What is price doing at this level, and do breadth and TICK support continuation, rejection, or exhaustion?" That framing turns market internals into decision aids rather than distractions.

Bullish continuation read	Bearish exhaustion read
• Higher timeframe or opening structure is supportive • Price pulls back into VWAP or a breakout retest and holds • Breadth stays healthy enough during the pullback • TICK resets and then turns back up as price stabilizes	• Price extends into a known resistance or expected-move edge • TICK becomes less supportive despite price pushing • Breadth stalls or stops broadening • A rejection candle or failed breakout gives the trigger

1. Locate the trade: What level or area makes this decision meaningful?
2. Classify the environment: trend, range, or event-driven repricing?
3. Confirm sponsorship: is breadth helping the idea or fighting it?
4. Time the entry: is TICK confirming momentum, or warning of exhaustion?
5. Define invalidation and size before you click.
6. Review afterward whether the trade made structural sense, even if P/L was positive.

A simple quality filter

If a setup looks good only because the indicator looks exciting, but you cannot explain the location, the invalidation, and the likely path of price, pass on the trade.

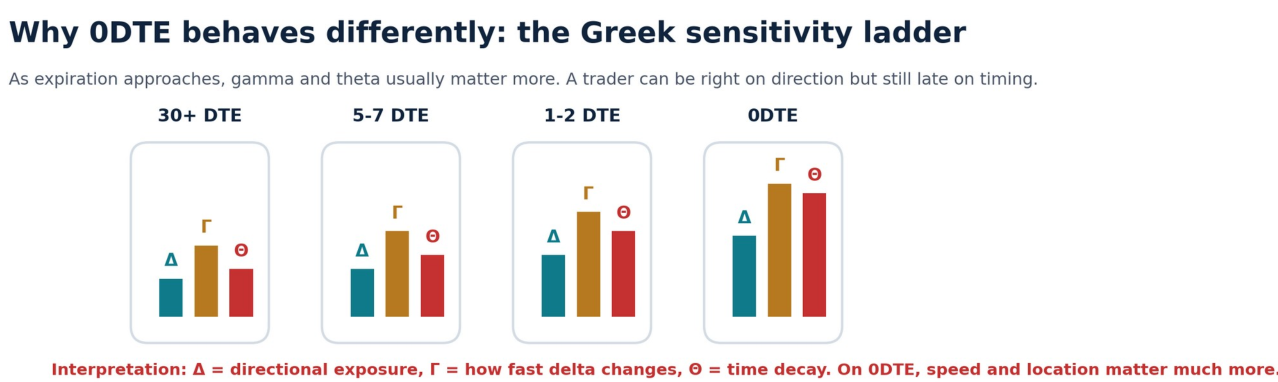
Part II - 0DTE mechanics and product choice

Same-day options can express an intraday view with small capital, but they compress both opportunity and error. They reward precision and punish hesitation, weak structure, and oversized emotion.

6. Why 0DTE behaves differently

0DTE refers to options that expire at the end of the current trading day. Because there is almost no time left, Greeks such as gamma and theta become far more sensitive to price movement and time decay than they are in options with more time remaining.

TL;DR	0DTE can move quickly in your favor, but it can also decay or reprice against you even when your directional idea is only slightly late.
Beginner	For beginners, the main lesson is simple: being "kind of right" is often not enough. You usually need the right direction, the right timing, and the right strike behavior.
Intermediate	Intermediate traders should understand how delta can change quickly near the money, why time decay accelerates as the session passes, and why a good chart pattern can still produce a poor options trade if entry is late.
Expert	Experts treat 0DTE as a microstructure product. They care about event timing, spread quality, strike selection, execution style, and whether a defined-risk spread better matches the thesis than raw long premium.



As expiration approaches, the option becomes more sensitive to timing. On 0DTE, product mechanics can overwhelm a merely average entry.

Why new traders get trapped	**Ways to simplify the learning curve**
• They buy the cheapest strike instead of the best-behaving strike • They chase after the initial impulse, so theta and spread cost immediately work against them • They treat a fast product as a substitute for a clean	• Practice the exact setup first in simulation • Use the underlying, shares, or micro futures to learn timing before adding option complexity • Prefer very liquid underlyings and avoid "lottery ticket" strikes

thesis • They widen stops because the premium looks small	• Consider defined-risk spreads once you understand how the structure changes payoff

Product note

Index options such as SPX and XSP are commonly cash-settled and European style, while ETF options such as SPY and QQQ are commonly physically settled and American style. That difference affects assignment and exercise risk. Verify the contract specifications of the exact product you trade.

7. Product selection: choose the tool that matches the trade

A clean trade thesis should drive product selection. The right product is the one that expresses the idea with the least unnecessary complexity, not the one that promises the largest percentage return in theory.

TL;DR	Match the product to the setup and your experience level. Complexity is not edge.
Beginner	If you are still learning intraday timing, practice the underlying or use the most liquid and most understandable structure available.
Intermediate	Intermediate traders can start matching structure to thesis: long premium for sharp expansion, debit spreads to cap cost, and limited-size trades when the expected path is strong but not explosive.
Expert	Experts compare strike behavior, implied volatility, spread quality, event risk, and the consequences of assignment or settlement. They also know when the best choice is to not use options at all.

Structure	Best use	Strengths	Watch-outs	Best fit
Underlying or micro futures	Best for learning structure and timing	Cleaner price behavior, less option decay complexity	Still leveraged; futures require strict risk control	Beginner to intermediate
ATM or slightly ITM long options	Fast directional view with strong expected move	More responsive than far OTM contracts	Time decay still punishes hesitation	Intermediate
Far OTM "cheap" options	Rarely justified except special event scenarios	Low ticket price	Low quality behavior, high decay, easy to chase	Avoid as a default
Debit spreads	Directional view with defined cost	Can reduce premium outlay and theta pain	Caps upside and needs planning	Intermediate to advanced
Naked short premium	Specialized intraday management only	Can benefit from decay	Margin, tail risk, and assignment complexity	Advanced only

A practical beginner rule: if the chart thesis is not clean enough to trade with the underlying, it is usually not clean enough to improve by wrapping it in 0DTE.

8. Execution matters more when the product is faster

Execution is where many good chart ideas fail. Same-day options magnify spread cost, late entries, emotional chasing, and indecision. Research on large 0DTE trade samples suggests that entry and exit timing materially influence outcomes; in plain language, not all minutes of the trading day behave the same.

TL;DR	The faster the product, the more you should care about entry quality, order type, and exit logic.
Beginner	Beginners should predefine the exact trigger, max loss, and what they will do if price immediately stalls.
Intermediate	Intermediate traders refine timing: they wait for a pullback, reclaim, failed retest, or rejection rather than paying peak emotional pricing at the first burst.
Expert	Experts optimize around liquidity windows, event clocks, and the relationship between price path and option sensitivity. They often use the simplest possible management plan because complexity is hard to execute in fast tape.

Execution checklist

- Check spreads and liquidity before entering
- Use limit orders whenever practical
- Enter at a level, not in the middle of nowhere
- Define the first target and the "nothing happened" exit

Management checklist

- Do not widen the stop because the premium feels cheap
- If the setup was a scalp, do not force it into a hold
- If breadth and TICK stop confirming, reduce or exit
- After one or two poor executions, reduce size before trying again

Late-entry tax

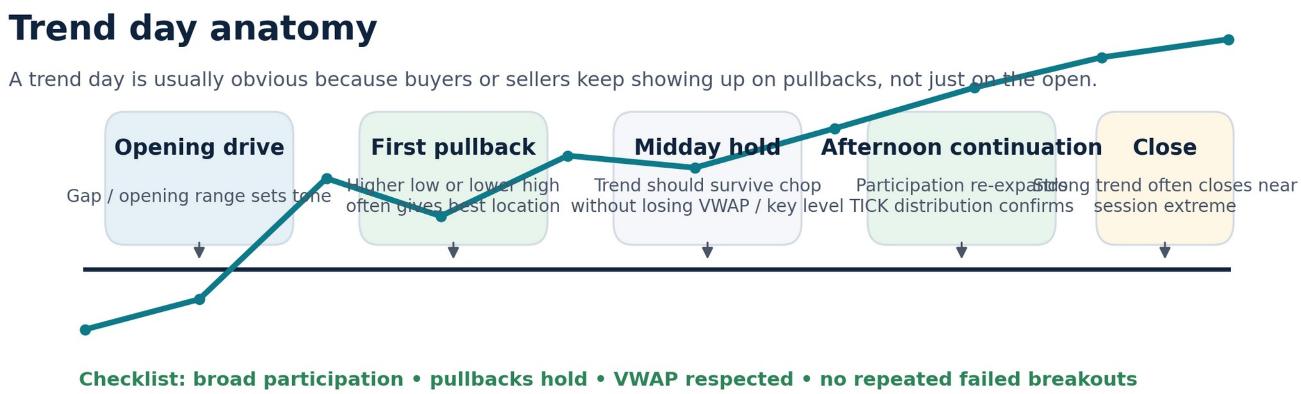
A common novice pattern is to wait for a move to look obvious, enter after the burst, and then watch premium decay while price simply pauses. The chart may still be fine, but the product is now mispriced for your entry.

Part III - Playbooks you can actually train

A playbook is a repeatable pattern with clear environmental requirements, an entry logic, and a risk logic. If a setup does not tell you when you are wrong, it is not a playbook yet.

9. Playbook 1: trend day continuation

This is often the cleanest momentum playbook. The market shows broad participation early, accepts higher or lower prices, and uses pullbacks to reset rather than to fully reverse.



Trend day anatomy: broad participation and orderly pullbacks usually matter more than buying every breakout candle.

TL;DR	On a real trend day, the edge is often in buying or selling the reset, not chasing the first impulse.
Beginner	Beginners should wait for the first or second orderly pullback that respects the market map.
Intermediate	Intermediate traders combine location, VWAP behavior, breadth, and TICK reset/re-expansion to time continuation entries.
Expert	Experts measure whether pullback quality is degrading. A true trend day keeps finding responsive buyers or sellers before the market fully reverts to value.

Trend day continuation setup sheet

Environment	Strong opening drive or accepted gap, healthy breadth, and repeated evidence that pullbacks are being defended.
What you should see	Price stays above VWAP in an uptrend or below VWAP in a downtrend; the advance-decline line and sector participation remain supportive; TICK cools during pullbacks and re-expands with the trend.
Entry logic	Wait for a pullback into VWAP, the opening range edge, a breakout retest, or another mapped level. Enter on stabilization, reclaim, or a fresh push when internals

	support continuation.
Risk logic	Risk to the structural level that would prove the pullback is no longer just a reset. Keep size smaller if the move is already extended.
What invalidates it	Acceptance back through VWAP or the defended level, repeated failed continuation attempts, or a clear internal deterioration that no longer matches a trend day thesis.
Advanced notes	For beginners, the first clean pullback is usually higher quality than the fifth chase. If you missed the clean entry, missing the trade is cheaper than buying emotional extension.

10. Playbook 2: exhaustion reversal at a meaningful level

Exhaustion reversals are attractive because they can offer tight risk, but they are also easier to force. The best ones happen after a one-sided move runs into a level that matters and the internal pulse stops supporting further extension.

TL;DR	Countertrend trading should be rarer and smaller than continuation trading.
Beginner	New traders should only attempt reversals at obvious levels after clear rejection, not because a move "feels too far."
Intermediate	Intermediate traders watch for price making a final push while TICK or breadth fails to confirm the extension, then wait for an actual rejection trigger.
Expert	Experts think in auction terms: exhaustion means aggressive participants failed to get paid for pressing the move. The reversal gains quality when the market quickly reclaims value after the failed extension.

Exhaustion reversal setup sheet

Environment	One-sided push into prior day high/low, overnight extreme, expected-move edge, or a major higher timeframe level after the move is already stretched.
What you should see	Price extends but struggles to hold new territory; TICK stops confirming or becomes less extreme; a rejection candle or failed auction appears.
Entry logic	Wait for rejection, then enter on a reclaim or failed retest so the trade is based on actual evidence of rejection rather than opinion.
Risk logic	Use smaller size than a continuation trade. Risk beyond the exhaustion extreme or the rejection level that should not be re-accepted.

What invalidates it	Clean acceptance through the level with renewed participation and no meaningful rejection.
Advanced notes	A reversal that immediately requires "just a little more room" often means the setup was not finished. Let the level prove itself first.

11. Playbook 3: range day mean reversion

Not every session wants to trend. Some days are designed to punish aggressive breakout traders by rotating back toward value after each attempted expansion. On these days, patience and smaller expectations matter more than speed.

TL;DR	Fade only the edges of the range, not the middle.
Beginner	Beginners should focus on obvious rejections near the session extreme and target the return toward VWAP or the middle of the range.
Intermediate	Intermediate traders use mixed breadth, failed breaks, and weak follow-through as evidence that mean reversion remains the more likely path.
Expert	Experts watch for regime shift. A range trade becomes dangerous the moment participation broadens and the market starts accepting prices outside the prior balance.

Range day mean-reversion setup sheet

Environment	Mixed breadth, repeated returns through VWAP, and multiple failed breakouts or breakdowns.
What you should see	The market rejects the edges of the range and spends most of the day auctioning around value rather than trending away from it.
Entry logic	Trade from the edge back toward the middle only after a clear rejection, failed breakout, or failed breakdown has appeared.
Risk logic	Keep targets smaller and more realistic. Risk just beyond the range extreme or the failed break level.
What invalidates it	A genuine expansion with sustained breadth and acceptance outside the range.
Advanced notes	The middle of the range is not a great place to invent a position. If you miss the edge, wait for the next edge.

12. Playbook 4: catalyst and event-day protocol

Scheduled macro events such as CPI, FOMC decisions, and major economic releases can change the character of the session in seconds. On those days, survival often comes from selectivity rather than activity.

TL;DR	Event days are not mandatory trading days.
Beginner	Beginners are often best served by waiting until after the release and the first reaction settles into actual structure.
Intermediate	Intermediate traders can trade event days only if they know exactly what their setup looks like after volatility expands.
Expert	Experts reduce exposure when uncertainty is high, use fewer but clearer trades, and accept that preserving capital through chaos is a professional decision.

Catalyst-day protocol sheet

Environment	Major scheduled announcement or unusually high uncertainty session.
What you should see	Fast repricing, wider candles, sudden reversals, and a much higher chance of slippage or false confidence from short-term moves.
Entry logic	Trade only after a clear post-event structure forms. If the market is still repricing randomly, wait.
Risk logic	Smaller size, fewer attempts, and constant dollar risk. If you need a wider stop, reduce size proportionally.
What invalidates it	If you cannot define the level, the trigger, and the invalidation in one sentence, you do not have a trade yet.
Advanced notes	A no-trade decision on a catalyst day is often higher quality than a forced trade with fast product exposure.

When a no-trade day is the right trade

- You are late to every setup and emotionally reactive
- Breadth and price keep changing character faster than you can adapt
- The event clock is too close for your setup to play out cleanly
- You already broke process rules earlier in the day

What to do instead

- Screenshot and annotate the session
- Mark where the real structure emerged after the event
- Review how TICK and breadth behaved at the key levels
- Treat the session as tuition, not as a missed paycheck

Part IV - Risk, psychology, and training progression

If the framework above helps you find better trades, risk management keeps those trades from turning one bad day into a deep drawdown. A strong trader survives first and scales second.

13. Risk architecture: survive first, scale later

A good setup does not justify a bad risk plan. Your process should define how much you can lose on one idea, how many attempts you allow yourself in a day, and what behavior forces you to stop even before the dollar loss is reached.

TL;DR	Risk should be defined before entry and anchored to invalidation, not to emotion.
Beginner	Beginners should use a fixed, small amount of risk per trade and a hard daily stop that ends the session.
Intermediate	Intermediate traders can size by structure: a tighter, cleaner invalidation can allow slightly larger size while keeping total risk constant.
Expert	Experts protect mental capital as well as money. Two impulsive rule breaks in a row are often more dangerous than one normal loss.

Risk framework: position size, trade stop, and daily stop work together. Remove one layer and the whole structure gets weaker.

Risk rules worth hard-coding	Rules that save many traders
• Set max trade risk before entry • Use a daily stop and honor it • No averaging down in fast products • Reduce size after process errors, not just after losses	• Three-strikes rule: after several poor executions, stop • No revenge trading after a sharp loss • No adding to a loser unless it was preplanned and still inside risk • If you cannot explain the exit, do not explain the entry

Layer	Purpose	Example question
Per-trade risk	Limits damage from one bad idea	What is my max loss if this thesis is wrong now?
Daily stop	Prevents one emotional session from snowballing	At what point does capital preservation take priority over opportunity?
Behavior stop	Prevents impulse from replacing process	Have I broken enough rules today that more trading is likely to be punishment, not edge?

14. Psychology is process under pressure

Most trading psychology problems are easier to fix upstream than in the middle of a fast move. A clear checklist, smaller size, and predefined invalidation solve more emotional errors than motivational slogans ever will.

TL;DR	Psychology improves when your process removes avoidable decisions.
Beginner	Beginners should focus on calm repetition: fewer trades, smaller size, and one setup repeated well.
Intermediate	Intermediate traders learn to recognize the emotional signatures of fear of missing out, revenge, and overconfidence after a quick win.
Expert	Experts know that discipline is a position-sizing tool. If behavior degrades with leverage, they move down the leverage ladder until execution quality returns.

Professional habits

- Trade only preplanned playbooks
- Pause before re-entry after a loss
- Review screenshots daily
- Use a written checklist before each order

Impulse traps

- Trading because the candle is big
- Believing a cheap premium means cheap risk
- Forcing countertrend trades because the market "should" reverse
- Trying to make back losses with size instead of quality

Behavioral rule

If you are using 0DTE mainly because it creates emotional excitement, that is already information: your product choice is working against your development.

15. Journaling and review: turn experience into data

A journal should capture more than P/L. It should tell you whether your edge came from context, timing, risk, or luck. The goal is to make your process more objective over time.

Journal field	Why it matters
Market type	Shows whether the playbook matched the session
Level traded	Forces location-based thinking
Breadth note	Documents whether the move had sponsorship
TICK note	Captures timing and exhaustion context
Setup / playbook	Allows pattern-level review
Product and size	Reveals whether complexity is helping or hurting
Planned stop and target	Separates planned trade from emotional management
Exit reason	Shows whether you followed the plan
Screenshot	Preserves the actual chart context
Process grade	Lets you distinguish good losses from bad mistakes

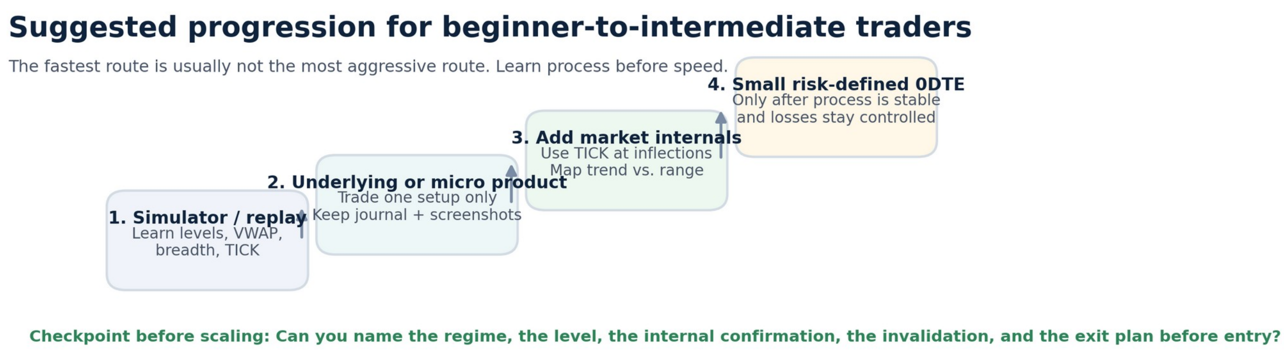
Post-trade review checklist
[ ] Did I correctly identify the market type before entry?
[ ] Was the trade placed at a meaningful level?
[ ] Did breadth support or weaken the idea?
[ ] Did TICK help confirm timing or warn of exhaustion?
[ ] Was the product appropriate for the thesis?
[ ] Was the size appropriate for my plan and emotional state?
[ ] Would I take the same trade again if P/L were hidden?

16. Training path: from beginner to intermediate without skipping steps

The fastest way to improve is usually to reduce complexity, not add it. Learn to diagnose the day and execute one or two playbooks cleanly before you try to optimize leverage, Greeks, or advanced structures.

TL;DR	Build skill in layers: market reading first, timing second, product complexity last.
Beginner	Beginners should start with simulation, shares, or micro futures and focus on one playbook with screenshot review.
Intermediate	Intermediate traders can add breadth and TICK filters, structured journaling, and limited exposure to liquid

	options once execution is already stable.
Expert	Experts earn the right to size up because the framework is internalized. They do not use complexity to compensate for unclear market reading.



Suggested development path: complexity should arrive after consistency, not before it.

Stage	Main goal	Graduation standard
Stage 1 - Simulator / low leverage	Learn market type, levels, and one playbook	You can explain location, invalidation, and exit before entry
Stage 2 - Structured live practice	Trade small with a fixed risk unit	Process execution is consistent across multiple weeks
Stage 3 - Intermediate options use	Match structure to thesis and respect liquidity	Product choice improves results instead of increasing chaos
Stage 4 - Size slowly and review deeply	Scale only proven behavior	You can protect capital during difficult conditions

Suggested 30-day development block

7. Week 1: Mark levels daily and classify the market type without placing live trades.
8. Week 2: Trade one playbook only in simulation and record screenshots before and after each trade.
9. Week 3: Add breadth and TICK notes to every setup and compare good trades with bad trades.
10. Week 4: If process is stable, take very small live risk only on A-grade setups and continue the same review routine.

17. Common mistakes that slow trader development

Mistakes in market reading

- Trading every opening burst as a breakout
- Ignoring whether the move is broad or narrow
- Forcing reversals without a meaningful level
- Using internals without a price thesis

Mistakes in product and execution

- Buying the cheapest strike instead of the best structure
- Chasing after the move is already extended
- Sizing up after one quick win
- Trying to make 0DTE fix an account-size problem

Myth to avoid

More indicators rarely create more edge. Usually they create more permission to take a mediocre trade.

18. One-page decision checklist

Before every trade, can you check every box?
[ ] I know whether the session is acting like a trend day, range day, or event day.
[ ] I marked the exact level or area that makes the trade meaningful.
[ ] Breadth is supportive, neutral, or clearly unsupportive - and I know which one it is.
[ ] NYSE TICK is being used at an inflection point, not in the middle of noise.
[ ] My trigger is specific: pullback hold, reclaim, failed retest, rejection, or clean break.
[ ] My invalidation is structural and written down before entry.
[ ] The product matches my skill level and the expected path of price.
[ ] My size fits my plan, my account, and my emotional state today.
[ ] I know what will make me take profits, reduce, or fully exit.
[ ] I am willing to pass if the checklist is incomplete.

Glossary and selected references

Use the glossary as a quick language bridge, then consult the reference list for deeper study. Always verify current product specifications and risk disclosures directly with the relevant exchange, broker, and issuer.

19. Glossary

Term	Plain-English definition
Advance-decline line	A running measure of whether more stocks are advancing or declining through the session.
ADD	Advance-decline issues; net advancing minus declining stocks at a point in time.
Balance day	A session that rotates around value instead of sustaining directional expansion.
Breadth	How broadly a move is supported across many stocks or sectors.
Delta	How much an option tends to change for a small move in the underlying, all else equal.
Gamma	How quickly delta itself changes as price moves.
Expected move	A market-implied estimate of the likely price range over a period.
Inflection point	A level or area where continuation, rejection, or reversal becomes more likely to be decided.

Term	Plain-English definition
IV / implied volatility	The volatility implied by option prices; affects premium levels and expected movement.
Mean reversion	A tendency for price to rotate back toward an average or value area after extension.
Opening range	The high-low range formed during the early part of the session that traders often use as a reference.
Pullback	A temporary move against the current impulse or trend.
TICK	The number of stocks trading on an uptick minus those trading on a downtick at a given moment.
Theta	The sensitivity of option value to the passage of time.

Term	Plain-English definition
Trend day	A session where directional expansion is accepted and pullbacks remain orderly.
VWAP	Volume-weighted average price; a common intraday reference for value and trend quality.

20. Selected references and source notes

The framework in this guide blends practitioner education on market internals with public options-education resources and risk documents. Use the latest versions of the sources below, since rules, products, and educational material can change.

Options Clearing Corporation - Characteristics and Risks of Standardized Options (latest edition) - Core risk disclosure for options traders; should be read before trading live.

Cboe - 0DTE Trading Resources - Overview material on same-day options, product context, and educational resources.

Cboe - 0DTEs Decoded: Positioning, Trends, and Market Impact - Context for how 0DTE volume, structure, and market impact are often misunderstood.

Cboe - Evaluating the Market Impact of SPX 0DTE Options - Useful for separating sensational headlines from structure and net exposure.

Fidelity Learning Center - Advance/Decline Line - Plain-language overview of breadth and participation.

Interactive Brokers glossary - TICK and TRIN - Compact definitions of common market internals.

Charles Schwab education notes on market breadth - Helpful framing for participation vs. price.

Option Alpha research on large 0DTE trade samples - Execution timing and trade management context; treat sample findings as informative, not universal.

SMB Training education on using NYSE TICK - Practical trader framing on using TICK around inflection points and exhaustion rather than in isolation.

Final reminder

The goal is not to predict every intraday move. The goal is to repeatedly trade situations where context, structure, participation, timing, product choice, and risk all line up well enough that the trade makes sense before the outcome is known.